High-Protein Ravioli Casserole

Main dishes | Oven

Before you start

Equipment: skillet, mixing bowl, and 9×13-inch baking dish. Oven: 400°F. Bake covered: 25-30 minutes, until hot and bubbly.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Meat seasonings

Bowl B - Cheese filling

- [ ] 24 oz fresh ravioli
- [ ] 32 oz marinara sauce
- [ ] 2 cups cottage cheese [Bowl B]

- [ ] 16 oz ricotta [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 cups shredded mozzarella
- [ ] 1/3 cup grated Parmesan
- [ ] 1 lb ground meat
- [ ] 1 tsp cumin [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp chili powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp onion powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] Salt and pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] Optional: basil, red pepper flakes, or spinach

1. Make meat sauce and cheese filling

1. Heat the oven to 400°F.

2. Brown 1 lb ground meat. Season with 1 tsp cumin, 1 tsp chili powder, 1/2 tsp paprika, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp onion powder, and salt and pepper to taste. Stir in 32 oz marinara sauce.

3. Mix 2 cups cottage cheese with 16 oz ricotta. Season to taste and fold in optional spinach. Divide this mixture into two equal portions.

2. Layer

1. Spread about 1 cup meat sauce in the baking dish. Add 12 oz fresh ravioli (half of the 24 oz), half the cottage cheese-ricotta mixture, and 1 cup shredded mozzarella.

2. Add the remaining meat sauce, remaining 12 oz ravioli, remaining cheese mixture, and remaining 1 cup mozzarella. Finish with 1/3 cup grated Parmesan.

3. Bake and serve

1. Cover and bake 25-30 minutes, until hot and bubbly. Let cool briefly before serving.

2. Add optional basil or red pepper flakes to taste.

Notes

Layering clarification: use half of the full cottage cheese-ricotta mixture in each layer. The source's longer instructions specify halves; its condensed recipe card says 1 cup per layer, which leaves some filling unused.

Prep clarification needed: The optional spinach has no quantity or prep state specified. Retain the optional amount and prepare it to your preference.